enforce a strict separation between those who do HTML and those who write scripts. Others draw the line between a graphic design group and an engineering group that does HTML and scripting. It can become inefficient for an HTML group to be requesting changes from a scripting group.

FastTemplate addresses this problem by separating HTML from PHP. Templates are written in HTML and may contain special codes surrounded by curly braces. A PHP script loads the templates, defines values for the special codes and replaces them. The codes may be replaced with other templates or with data created by PHP. The implication is that people unable to work with PHP code will be comfortable working with template files that better resemble plain HTML. Small changes to the HTML can be made without interaction with the engineers, who might be grumpy about making changes. In addition, the engineers will not have to worry about novices introducing errors into their scripts.

9.6 MIDGARD

Another approach to Web site design with PHP is the Midgard project. The maintainers are Jukka Zitting and Henri Bergius. Rather than code a solution in PHP alone, they have pursued integrating PHP into their own application server. Midgard is capable of organizing more than 800,000 pages of content using a Web-based interface. For this reason it is ideal for operating Magazine sites.

Keyword

Content management system is software that helps users create, manage, and modify content on a website without the need for specialized technical knowledge.

Midgard is an open source persistent storage framework. It provides an object-oriented and replicated environment for building data-intensive applications.

Midgard also ships with MidCOM **content management system (CMS)** built on the Midgard framework. MidCOM's features include web-based authoring WYSIWYG interfaces and a component interface for installing additional web functionalities, including wikis and blogs.

Midgard is an open source project, of course. You can download an official release, or grab a snapshot through CVS. In order to install it, you must modify PHP slightly, but instructions are available at the Midgard site. Because it requires compilation, running Midgard on Windows is probably not worth the effort.